

Costs and Lost Time for Employees whose Spouses Have Dementia and/or Alzheimer's Disease and Patient Direct Costs

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Background

- In the United States,¹ nearly 7 million people are living with Alzheimer's disease (AD), the most common cause of dementia (DEM).
- >11m Americans provide unpaid care for people with AD or DEM, estimated as 8.4b hours and ~\$350b in 2023
- Some unpaid care comes from spouses who are Caregivers (CGs) using Discretionary Incidental Time-off (DITO) and Family Medical Leaves (FMLs) for care of a spouse patient (PAT)
- Caregivers' health and costs are impacted after becoming a CG.
- The Society of Actuaries 2024 survey reported:²
 - 13% of male and female pre-retirees provide care or have provided care to loved ones who are not minor children, while 38% say they are unprepared to offer any help for a family member's medical emergency or health issue
 - Caregivers are most concerned about the emotional and/or physical toll for male and female pre-retirees (36% and 26% respectively)

Objectives

- Examine annual medical, prescription (Rx), FML, and DITO trends for caregiver (care partner) employees of spouses with Alzheimer's disease (AD), dementia (DEM), or BOTH.
- Examine medical and Rx claims for patients with AD, DEM, or BOTH.

Study Population

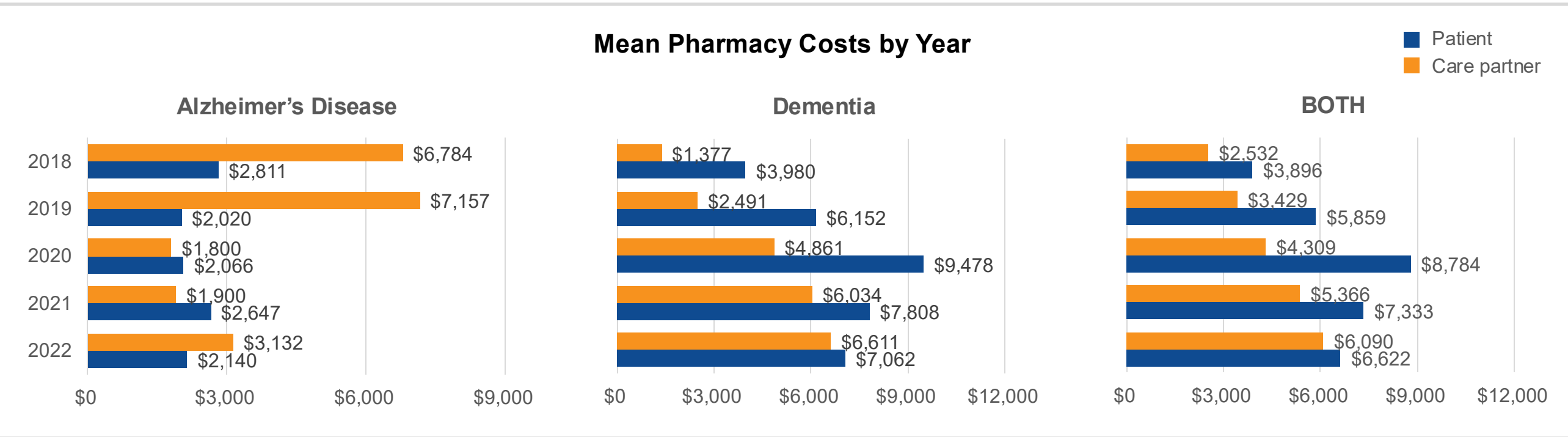
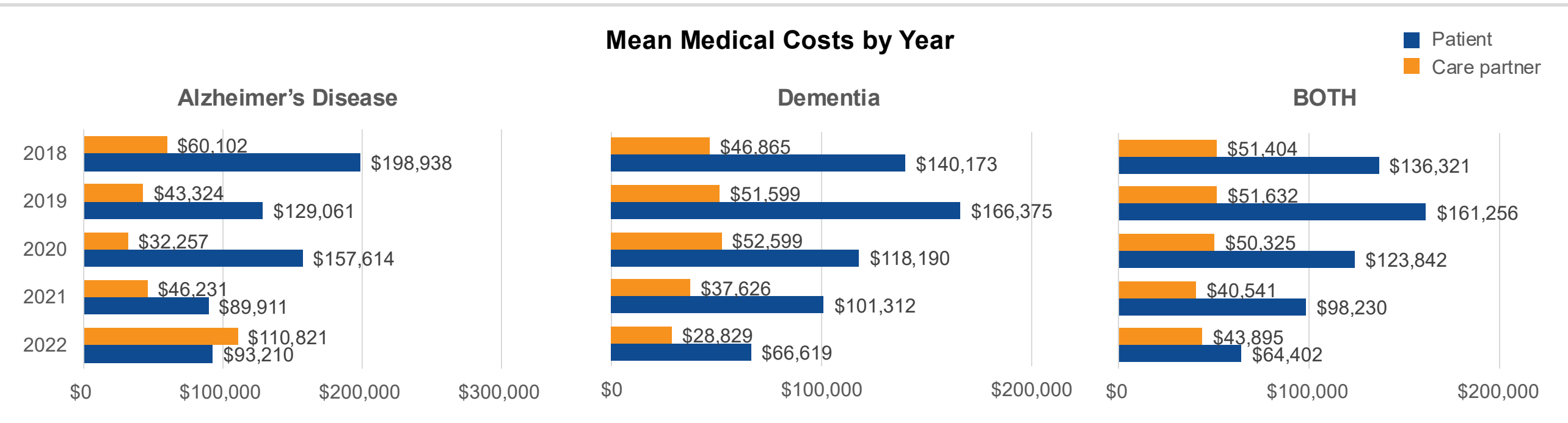
- The Workpartners Research Reference Database (RRDb)³⁻⁸ contains
 - Health plan medical and Rx claims
 - Enhanced demographics (including race, marital status, salary, job type, full/part-time status, exempt/non-exempt status)
 - Absence and disability (short- and long-term), Workers' Compensation claims (with durations and payments)
 - FML durations
- The RRDb includes over 5.5 million employees and dependents in all 50 states, from 2001 to present. Employees are linked to their dependents.
- The RRDb has been used in prior employee³⁻⁴ and caregiver⁵⁻⁸ research.

Methods

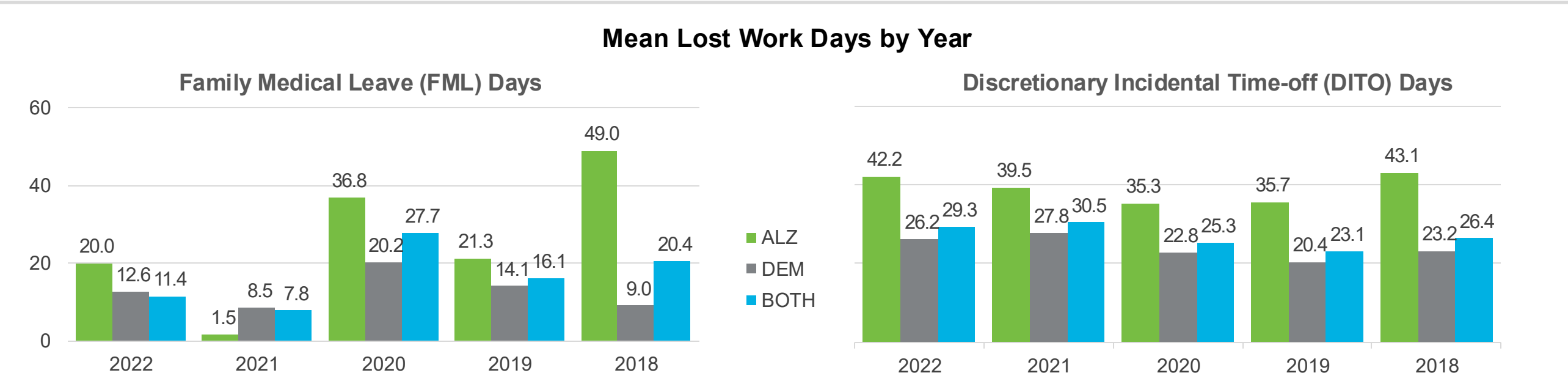
- Retrospective analysis of US patients in the RRDb (2018—2022).
- Patients** were identified by ICD-10 codes:
 - G30, G300, G301, G308, or G309 for Alzheimer's disease
 - F01, F015, F0150, F0151, F02, F028, F0280, F0281, F03, F039, G310, G3109, G3183 for dementia
 - For Alzheimer's disease OR dementia for BOTH
- Patients and care partners** had ≥ 1 year continuous data following **patient's** initial Dx (Index Year) and were analyzed based on Index Year.
- The following outcomes were reported based on the Index Year:
 - Caregiver:** FML claims filed, days missed under DITO and FML; per member per month (PMPM) medical, prescription, and total costs
 - Patient:** The % and trends of PMPM medical, prescription, and total costs
- Per patient per year (PPPY) costs adjusted to December 2023 US dollars.

Results

- We identified 2851 **care partner** and **patient pairs** with (AD=23.8%, DEM=79.2%) 10.2% were Dx'd with either (BOTH).
- Patient age decreased from 63.9 to 62.6 for those with Alzheimer's disease, from 56.1 to 54.3 for those with Dementia, and 56.7 to 54.5 for those with BOTH.
- All cohorts had increases in the percent of female patients during the observation period.



- The majority of MED\$ were for patients (average 70.9% for AD, 74.6% for DEM and 72.2% for BOTH).
- Family medical leave (FML) claims were filed by 13% of the employee caregivers.



Conclusions

- As the diagnosis age for patients with dementia and Alzheimer's disease decreases, more employees will be impacted, either as patients or by assuming the role of a caregiver.
- Employees may require time off to manage their affected partners, or themselves.
- Although medical and Rx costs have declined since 2018, there has been
 - A significant increase in Family Medical Leave Absences (FMLA), leading to a loss of more than two weeks of worker productivity in 2021, 2022
 - An upward (though less linear) trend in DITO days
 - And may changes in costs for their covered lives (PAT+CG) and the impact of these conditions on employee absences

Limitations

- While this research was focused on employees caring for spouses, it was unknown if other support persons were available.
- Diagnoses were based on claims and could not be verified.

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